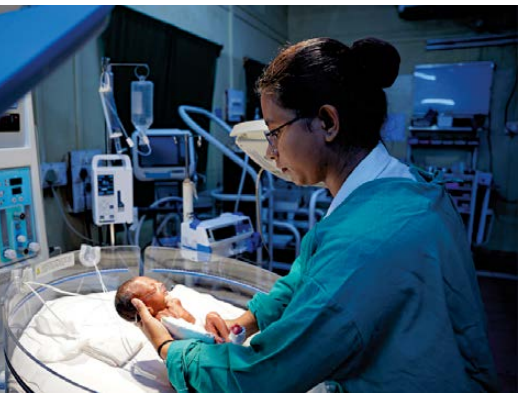
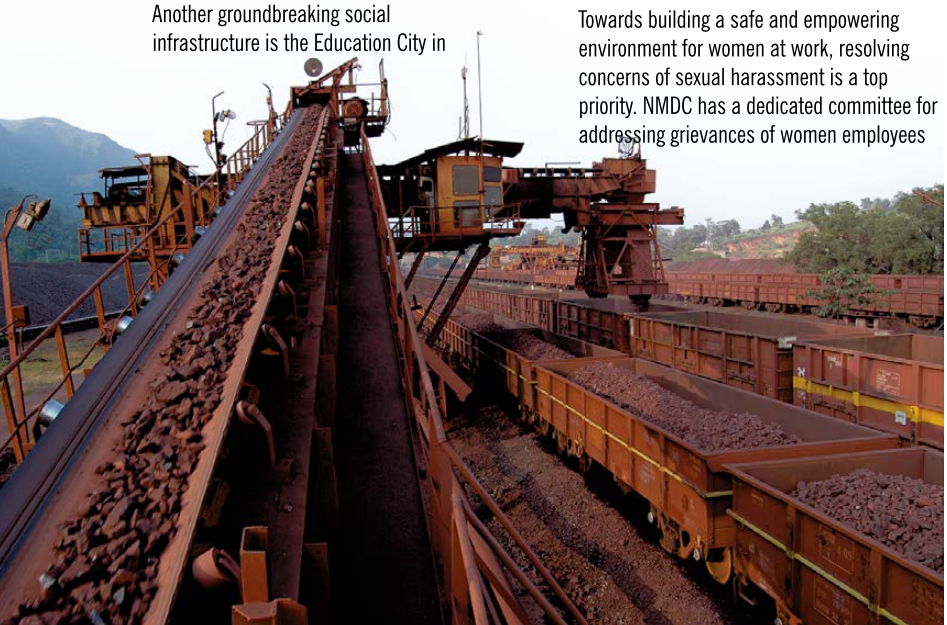


that is brimming with opportunities and value for the community living around our mines. The company has been working for close to seven decades towards this goal. Over the last decade, we have invested around Rs. 1800 crores in CSR expenditures, with a focus on education, skill development, healthcare access, clean drinking water, sanitation, and community infrastructure development.

One of our greatest accomplishments is the robust health care infrastructure at NMDC Projects, which extends quality medical care to the local communities free of cost. Currently 25,000 in-patients and 1,00,000 out-patients are being treated at our Project Hospitals annually. Post NMDC's intervention, Bastar in Chhattisgarh witnessed a significant drop in Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) and Maternal Mortality Rate (MMR) and we continue to support Anganwadis and the State's efforts to eliminate malnutrition. For the villagers who cannot commute to the hospital, NMDC has introduced Hospital on Wheels which takes primary healthcare to doorsteps.

Another groundbreaking social infrastructure is the Education City in Chhattisgarh which houses Saksham - school for specially-abled students, Aastha Gurukul - residential school for students who have lost their parents due to violence in the region and Polytechnic College for the technical education of youth. One of its kind in the country, Saksham is a residential school for children with special needs that provides barrier-free access to education to visually impaired, hearing impaired, physically and mentally challenged students. When the honourable Prime Minister of India visited the school, he appreciated Saksham and suggested emulation of the model across the country.



As a leader, what role do you believe gender diversity plays in fostering a sustainable business and society? How is NMDC supporting the professional growth of women within its organization and in society?

Gender diversity is the key to building sustainable and resilient businesses. Women in the workforce and in leadership positions are transforming societies, economies, and nations across the world, there is no two ways about it.

Women bring unique experiences, perspectives, and skills to leadership as we have experienced with women as Heads of Departments at NMDC. It must however be acknowledged that gender diversity in the mining sector across the world is a slow transformation. Women employees constitute close to 7% of NMDC's workforce, which is one of the highest in mining companies of the subcontinent and still considerably low. We are positive of the future, there is a paradigm shift in recruitment as we are onboarding women in good numbers in the service departments.

Towards building a safe and empowering environment for women at work, resolving concerns of sexual harassment is a top priority. NMDC has a dedicated committee for addressing grievances of women employees along with WIPS (Women in Public Sector) Cells at all our Project locations. NMDC's Head Office and Nagarnar Plant, where majority of our women employees are stationed, have creche facilities. At our townships in remote locations, NMDC's Mahila Samitis run daycare centers at play schools and young mothers have flexible working hours. At NMDC, we also encourage sports among our women workforce with women leagues in inter-project tournaments.

In creating value for the women of the community, NMDC has ensured quality education and healthcare facilities for them. Our flagship CSR initiative Balika Shiksha Yojana in its decade of service has contributed to the journey of over 500 tribal girl students becoming healthcare professionals of the country and agents of change in their villages. Encouraging higher education, 44% of the beneficiaries of our scholarship scheme Shiksha Sahayog Yojana are girl students. NMDC takes pride in supporting the journeys of young women from the hinterlands of India.

Considering the dynamic nature of the mining industry, how does NMDC adapt to changes and emerging trends while maintaining a focus on sustainability and ethical practices?

In the fast-paced and ever-evolving mining industry, NMDC recognizes the importance of adaptability to stay at the forefront. We prioritize staying abreast of emerging trends and changes to ensure that our operations remain efficient, sustainable, and aligned with ethical practices.

One key aspect of our adaptability is a robust research and development strategy. NMDC invests in cutting-edge technologies and collaborates with industry experts to understand and implement innovations that enhance operational efficiency while minimizing environmental impact. This commitment to technological advancements allows us to stay ahead of the curve in the mining sector.

Sustainability is a core pillar of our business philosophy. This is evident through our GRI Standards-based Sustainability Report. We prioritize ESG initiatives, aiming to contribute meaningfully to climate change mitigation. Recognized with 5-star ratings for our mines by the Ministry of Mines, we conduct extensive environmental monitoring studies and GHG accounting, preserve biodiversity through extensive plantation efforts at project locations, and invest in green energy transition with Solar and Wind energy projects.